

United Overseas Bank (UOBH.SI)

Heavy provisions taken but uncertainties remain; down to Neutral

UOBH.SI

12m Price Target: **S\$38.00**Price: **S\$33.86**Upside: **12.2%**

We downgrade UOB to Neutral from Buy reflecting a relative call as we see strong upside potential elsewhere, while asset quality concerns, particularly in HK and US CRE segments are likely to linger in the near term. In 3Q25, UOB set aside S\$615mn pre-emptive general provisions amid ongoing macroeconomic uncertainties and sector-specific headwinds, mainly for the CRE sector exposure in the US and Greater China. This lifted general provisions to performing loan coverage ratio to 1% from 0.8% in 2Q25, bringing coverage ratios closer to peers, and GP coverage ratios in the US and Greater China increased to 2.2%/2.3% respectively. We view these additional provisions as a prudent step that strengthens balance sheet resilience. Nonetheless, limited disclosures on NPLs and other potentially vulnerable CRE loans and corresponding coverage levels, make it difficult to fully assess the adequacy of buffers, especially with UOB noting that GP coverage will be maintained at 0.9-1.0%. As such, we see near-term valuations may be capped, trading at 10-year historical median P/B, until greater visibility emerges on asset quality. That said, we are encouraged that UOB has delivered stronger momentum in wealth management in both fee income and AUM growth coupled with a pick-up in deposit growth, which will help support the growth in NII and non-NII, which should limit downside risk. Since we upgraded UOB to Buy on Nov 10, 2024, its shares have declined 5% vs. +21% for STI, underperforming we think due to asset quality issues, and outperformance of small- and mid-cap stocks in STI due to anticipation of the S\$5bn MAS program to boost local stock markets.

Key investment thesis

- **Negative - Uncertainties still ahead, more clarity and confidence needed for CRE exposure despite higher general provision coverage.** In 3Q25, UOB allocated S\$615mn pre-emptive general provisions amid ongoing macroeconomic uncertainties and sector-specific headwinds, mainly for the CRE

NEUTRAL

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Key Data

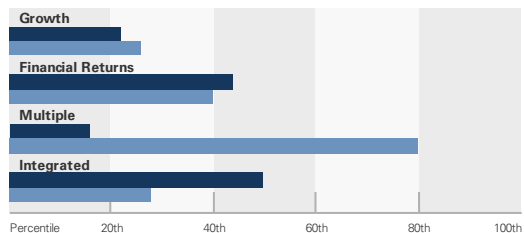
Market cap: S\$56.3bn / \$43.3bn
3m ADTV: S\$111.2mn / \$86.2mn
Singapore
Asean Financials
M&A Rank: 3

GS Forecast

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Net inc. (S\$ mn) New	6,044.0	4,613.7	5,619.2	5,998.0
Net inc. (S\$ mn) Old	6,044.0	5,474.0	5,824.0	6,245.2
EPS (S\$) New	3.51	2.70	3.31	3.54
EPS (S\$) Old	3.51	3.22	3.43	3.68
EPS growth (%)	6.0	(23.1)	22.4	6.9
P/E (X)	8.9	12.5	10.2	9.6
P/B (X)	1.1	1.2	1.1	1.0
Price/PPOP (X)	6.9	7.3	7.2	6.8
Dividend yield (%)	7.3	4.5	5.1	5.4

	9/25	12/25E	3/26E	6/26E
EPS (S\$)	0.26	0.77	0.86	0.81

GS Factor Profile



■ UOBH.SI relative to Asia ex. Japan Coverage
■ UOBH.SI relative to Asean Financials

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
See disclosures for details.

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NEUTRAL

United Overseas Bank (UOBH.SI)

Rating since Nov 9, 2025

Ratios & Valuation

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
P/E (X)	8.9	12.5	10.2	9.6
Price/PPOP (X)	6.9	7.3	7.2	6.8
P/B (X)	1.1	1.2	1.1	1.0
P/NTA per share (X)	—	—	—	—
Dividend yield (%)	7.3	4.5	5.1	5.4
Div. payout ratio (%)	64.2	55.0	50.0	50.0

Growth & Margins (%)

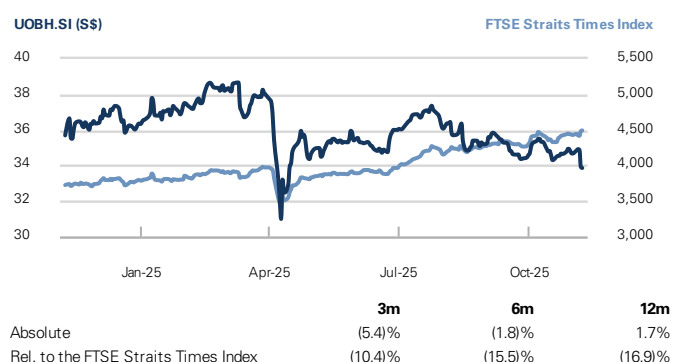
	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
BVPS growth	8.1	3.4	5.9	6.1
Total revenue growth	2.6	(2.5)	0.9	4.8
Op. profit growth	0.8	(5.5)	0.1	6.3
Net inc growth	5.8	(23.7)	21.8	6.7
EPS growth	6.0	(23.1)	22.4	6.9
DPS growth	35.3	(33.7)	13.1	6.7

Asset Quality

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Provision charge/total loans (%)	0.3	0.6	0.3	0.3
Gr impaired assets/total loans (%)	1.5	1.6	1.6	1.7
NPL ratio (%)	1.5	1.6	1.6	1.7
Total provisions/total loans (%)	1.2	1.4	1.4	1.4
Specific prov/gr impair assets (%)	31.7	30.7	30.8	30.7
Loan loss reserve/NPLs (%)	75.5	83.1	85.8	86.4

Capital Item

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Basel 3 CET1 ratio (%)	—	—	—	—
Tier 1 capital ratio (%)	16.6	16.0	16.0	16.3

Price Performance

Source: FactSet. Price as of 7 Nov 2025 close.

Income Statement (\$\$ mn)

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Net interest income	9,675.0	9,325.4	9,191.1	9,490.3
Net fees	2,395.0	2,581.9	2,843.5	3,160.1
Treasury income	1,689.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Other operating income	535.0	2,031.0	2,036.1	2,099.3
Total revenue	14,294.0	13,938.3	14,070.7	14,749.7
Compensation & benefits exp.	(3,699.0)	—	—	—
Non-employee costs	(2,376.0)	(6,172.2)	(6,295.6)	(6,484.5)
Pre-provision op. profit	8,219.0	7,766.1	7,775.0	8,265.1
Provision for loans	(873.0)	(1,976.6)	(1,070.8)	(1,108.8)
Total provision expense	(926.0)	(2,198.6)	(1,070.8)	(1,108.8)
Income/(loss) from associates	121.0	60.0	84.0	88.2
Pre-tax profit	7,151.0	5,610.5	6,788.2	7,244.5
Provision for taxes	(1,092.0)	(981.8)	(1,154.0)	(1,231.6)
Minority interest	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	6,044.0	4,613.7	5,619.2	5,998.0
Post-tax exceptionals	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	5,925.7	4,495.4	5,500.9	5,879.6
EPS (basic, pre-exception) (\$\$)	3.58	2.77	3.45	3.68
EPS (diluted, pre-exception) (\$\$)	--	--	--	--
EPS (basic, post-exception) (\$\$)	--	--	--	--
EPS (diluted, post-exception) (\$\$)	3.51	2.70	3.31	3.54
Wtd avg shares out. (diluted) (mn)	1,685.9	1,662.9	1,662.9	1,662.9
Avg. yield on loans (%)	5.2	4.4	3.8	3.7
Gr yld. on int. earning assets (%)	4.6	3.9	3.2	3.0
Cost of fund (%)	3.0	2.3	1.6	1.5
Net interest margin (%)	1.9	1.8	1.7	1.7

Balance Sheet (\$\$ mn)

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Domestic mortgages	82,036.0	86,300.8	88,656.2	93,122.0
Domestic non-mortgages	29,914.0	30,507.2	31,339.8	32,918.4
Domestic commercial lending	206,447.0	216,093.2	221,991.0	233,173.2
Total overseas lending, gross	—	—	—	—
Gross loans to customers	337,831.0	354,486.7	364,161.7	382,505.3
Total NPLs, gross	5,164.0	5,773.1	6,003.5	6,382.4
Total loan loss reserve	3,901.0	4,797.1	5,149.2	5,511.4
Net customer loans & advances	333,930.0	349,689.6	359,012.5	376,994.0
Other interest earning assets	85,943.0	93,033.8	95,050.0	97,143.5
Interest earning assets	509,163.0	533,013.5	559,151.2	583,535.4
Other non-int. earning assets	28,501.0	29,038.6	28,957.4	28,877.9
Total assets	537,664.0	562,052.2	588,108.6	612,413.4
Risk weighted assets	259,835.0	276,467.4	289,284.3	301,239.5
CASA deposits	220,644.0	253,894.8	284,362.2	307,111.2
Non-CASA deposits	183,334.0	171,409.6	165,204.4	163,715.1
Customer deposits	403,978.0	425,304.4	449,566.6	470,826.3
Other paying liabilities	—	—	—	—
Other liabilities	19,879.0	21,791.0	21,791.0	21,791.0
Total liabilities	487,707.0	511,124.7	535,386.8	556,646.5
Total shareholders' equity	49,957.0	50,927.5	52,721.8	55,766.8
Total liabilities & equity	537,664.0	562,052.2	588,108.6	612,413.4
BVPS (\$\$)	27.87	28.83	30.52	32.38
RWA/assets (%)	48.3	49.2	49.2	49.2

Profit Drivers

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Net customer loan growth (%)	5.3	4.7	2.7	5.0
Net interest margin (%)	1.9	1.8	1.7	1.7
Fee income ratio (%)	NM	NM	NM	NM
Cost/income (ex. goodwill) (%)	42.3	44.2	44.7	44.0
Tax rate (%)	15.3	17.5	17.0	17.0
CASA ratio (%)	54.6	59.7	63.3	65.2
Net cust. loans/deposits (%)	82.7	82.2	79.9	80.1

Profitability

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Op. revenue/avg. assets (%)	2.7	2.5	2.4	2.5
Op. expenses/avg. assets (%)	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.1
Pre-provision ROA (%)	1.5	1.4	1.4	1.4
Loan loss prov./avg. assets (%)	0.2	0.4	0.2	0.2
Pre-tax profit/avg. assets (%)	1.3	1.0	1.2	1.2
Prov. for inc. tax/avg. assets (%)	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2
ROA (%)	1.1	0.8	1.0	1.0
Leverage (X)	10.8	11.0	11.2	11.0
ROE (%)	13.1	9.5	11.3	11.5
ROE (pre-exception.) (%)	12.5	9.1	10.8	11.1

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

sector exposure in the US and Greater China. With that, general provisions to performing loan coverage ratio increased to 1% from 0.8% in 2Q25, closer to peers' coverage level, and GP coverage ratios in the US and Greater China increased to 2.2%/2.3% respectively. While overall coverage is now closer to peer levels, we note ex US and China GP coverage is at 0.72%, higher than 0.66% in 2Q25 but lower than 4Q24 levels of 0.76% and 3Q24 levels of 0.9%. Given ongoing uncertainties in the CRE sector especially in Greater China and US, we think further potential losses cannot be ruled out. We view the lack of disclosure regarding the level of NPLs, the proportion of special mention or other performing vulnerable exposures along with limited visibility on their corresponding coverage ratios and LTV for the CRE portfolio in these 2 markets, makes it difficult to take comfort that current provisions are sufficient, especially when UOB intends to sustain overall general provision coverage at 0.9%-1% with GP coverage ex US and China lower than it was last year. For now, we forecast 2026-27E credit cost of 30bps, at the higher end of normalized range from a conservative stance.

- **Positive - Improving wealth and deposit inflows to support revenue.** UOB recorded S\$5bn net new money in 3Q25, rising from average of S\$3bn in past 6 quarters. This, combined with improving market sentiment, drove wealth fee growth to 16% qoq/ +19% yoy, supporting overall fee income growth. Furthermore, deposit growth also accelerated in 3Q25, to +5%yoy. As we previously noted, the strategy of sourcing deposits and investing in high quality assets or deploying through wealth segment is highly ROE accretive, generating ROEs of 15%-36%. We expect the improving momentum in wealth and deposit growth to help support the NII and non-NII of UOB.
- **Positive - Fair valuation.** UOB's 12m forward P/B of 1.12X is close to the median of its ten-year historical range. We see UOB's current valuation justified by its ROA outlook, with GSe 2026-27E ROA average of 0.98% vs. 2015-2024 average of 0.97%. Furthermore, on a P/E basis, UOB is trading at 10.3X, close to its ten-year median.

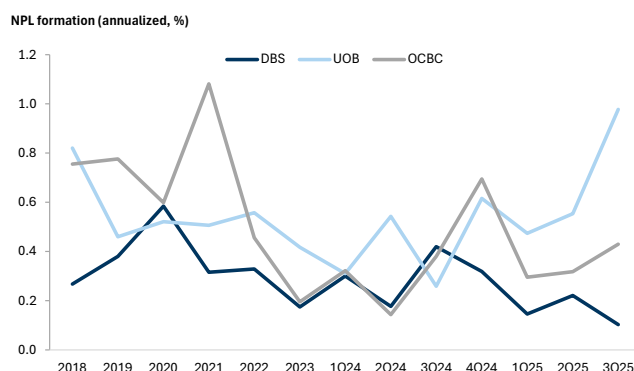
Post results, we revise down our earnings by -15.7%/-3.5%/-4.0% for 2025/26/27 respectively, to bake in (1) Higher credit cost realized in 3Q25, (2) lower fee income growth factoring in the higher fee cost in 3Q25 (3) Slower loan growth as guided by UOB for 2026. We revise down TP to S\$38.0 from S\$42.10 based on two-stage DDM, implying 12% upside, vs average upside of 13% of our ASEAN banks coverage.

Key risks:

- **Downside: Unexpected acceleration or sharper Fed rate cuts** could see NIMs falling faster than expected vs. our estimates and pose a risk to our net interest income forecasts.
- **Downside: Unexpected further sharp rise in NPLs for CRE portfolio** over and above UOB expectations could lead to further need to add to provisions which would put pressure on earnings.
- **Upside: Stronger than expected growth in fee income** such as credit card fees and wealth management fees as it continues to push out more lifestyle credit card

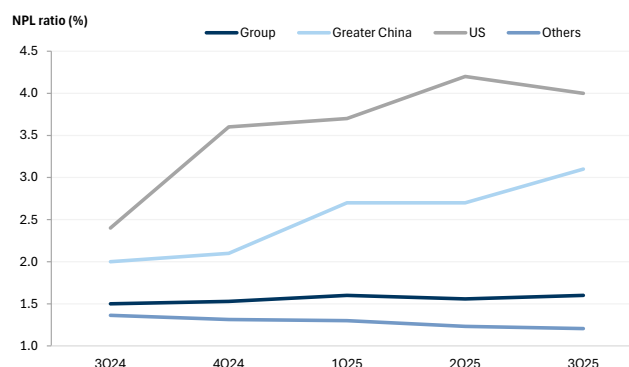
promotions and with larger franchise in ASEAN with the acquisition of Citi ASEAN drawing in more AUM.

Exhibit 1: UOB NPL formation rose to 1% in 3Q25...



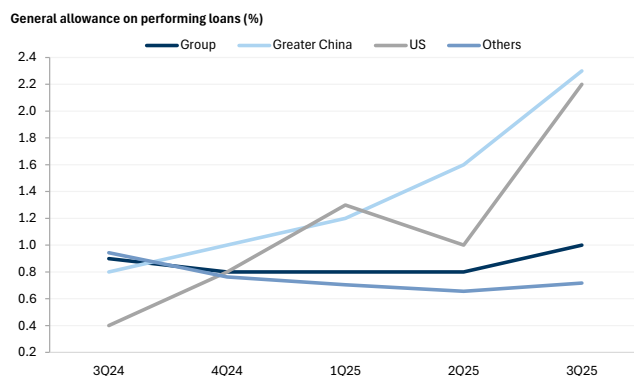
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: ...with higher NPL in Greater China and elevated NPL in the US



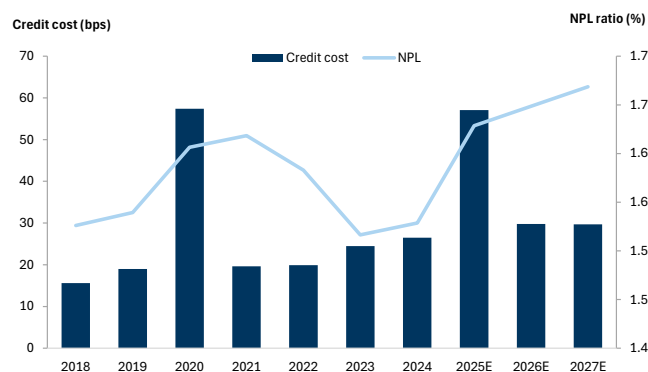
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: UOB increased general provision coverage to 1%, with US and greater China coverage rising to 2.2%/2.3% respectively



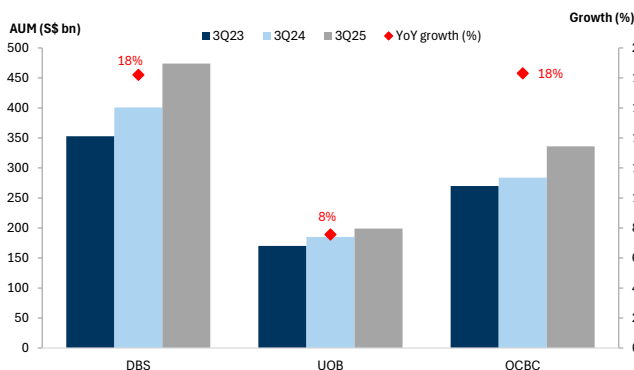
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: Despite the higher GP coverage, we expect 2026-27 credit cost to remain at 30bps, at the high end of normalized level of 25-30bps



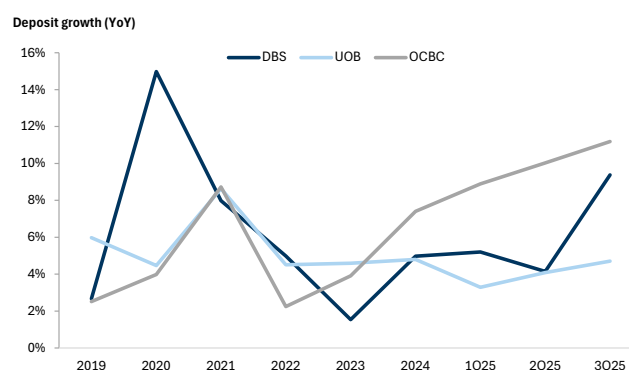
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: UOB delivered decent AUM growth of 8% yoy, but tracking below peers



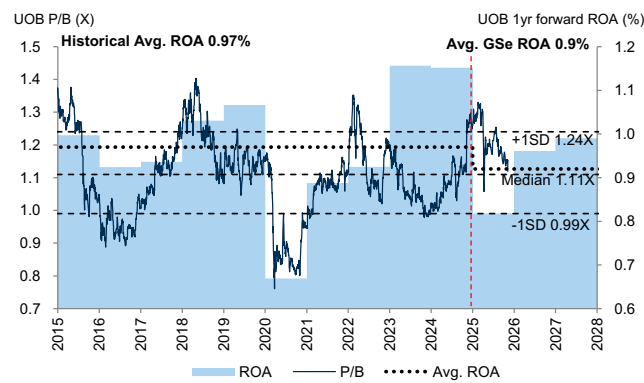
Source: Company data

Exhibit 6: UOB showed improving momentum in deposit growth, but also tracking below peers growth



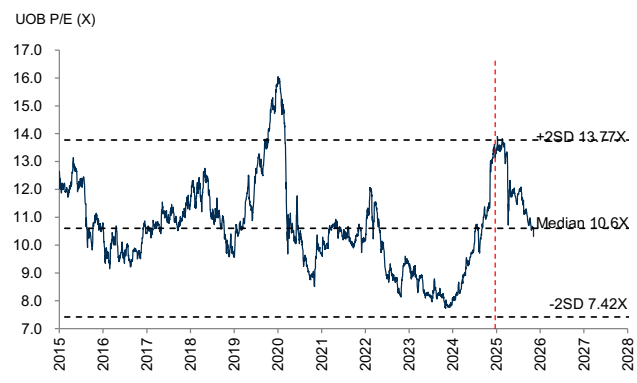
Source: Company data

Exhibit 7: UOB is currently trading at 1.12X forward P/B, close to its historical median



Source: Bloomberg, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 8: UOB is currently trading at 9.6X forward P/E, below its 10-year historical median



Source: Bloomberg, Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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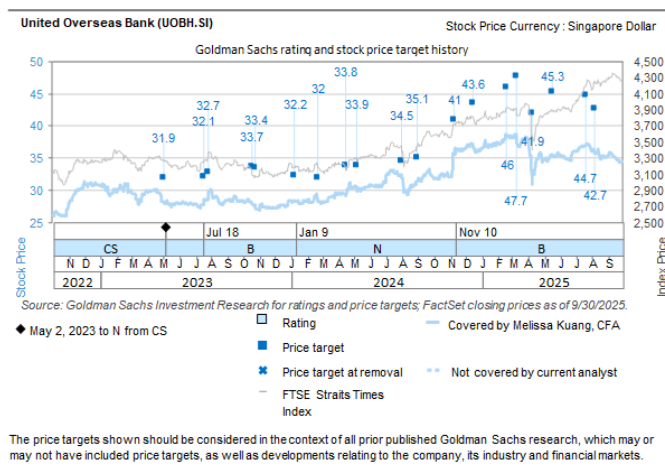
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	Buy	Hold	Sell		Buy	Hold	Sell
Global	49%	34%	17%		63%	58%	42%

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Price target and rating history chart(s)



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